

ZACHARY ELLERBROOK

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Cybersecurity | Active Secret Clearance | U.S. Navy (separating 2027)

SUMMARY

Security and compliance practitioner with two years of access control and personnel security administration inside a federal, RMF-governed environment. Designated NMCI Telecommunications Officer and Security Manager Liaison for a 35-40-person Navy organization — SAAR-N authorization review, least-privilege verification, account lifecycle, and clearance tracking, with Privacy Act PII handling throughout. Currently owns the command's migration of 32 enterprise workstations to the Navy's Nautilus environment as its only IT resource. Backed by 24 years of program management under external audit, plus hands-on Linux administration, a home pentesting lab, and a Python log-analysis tool built from scratch. Active Secret clearance (Tier 3R, adjudicated Jan 2023, Continuous Evaluation). SkillBridge-available from late February 2027; separates 30 June 2027.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Security: Access control & authorization review (SAAR-N) · Personnel security & clearance administration · Account lifecycle (joiner-mover-leaver) · Least-privilege provisioning · PII handling (Privacy Act) · Log analysis · SOC fundamentals (TryHackMe SOC Level 1) · Network fundamentals (Fortinet) · Vulnerability & exploitation basics (Kali, Metasploit — lab)

Systems: Linux (Arch/CachyOS daily driver, EndeavourOS, Ubuntu Server) · Windows 10/11 · Microsoft 365 / NMCI Flank Speed · VirtualBox

Tools & languages: Python · Bash · Git/GitHub · pytest · SharePoint permissions administration

EXPERIENCE

IT Systems Technician & Security Manager Liaison — U.S. Navy, Navy Band Great Lakes, IL

Nov 2025 – Present · collateral IT support duties since 2024

- Designated NMCI Telecommunications Officer and Security Manager Liaison — sole point of contact for network access, endpoint support, and personnel-security administration for a 35-40-person command.
- Own the unit's ongoing migration of 32 enterprise workstations to the Navy's Nautilus environment as the command's sole IT resource — 15 were converted before the role transferred to me; the remaining 17 are mine to carry through cutover.
- Diagnosed the constraint that had stalled the migration — the absence of scanning capability on converted systems — and resumed the conversion path once a deployed printer update restored it.
- Sequenced the remaining conversions at one workstation per day, phasing cutover around a live performance schedule that takes operational priority so no rehearsal or performance commitment is disrupted; coordinate authorization directly with Navy Music IT and the command's department head.
- Review SAAR-N system authorization requests for completeness, accuracy, and correct access level; submit and track MAC actions through NMCI to completion.
- Submit and track SharePoint and file-share permission requests provisioned by rank and collateral duty, verifying need-to-know before routing — applying least-privilege in practice.
- Submit account dormancy requests and Nautilus principal-user change requests; process All-Hands distribution list modifications as the command population changes.
- Track command-wide security clearance expirations and maintain personnel rosters; screen access packages against clearance status and route to the NSTC Security Manager for SF-86 adjudication.
- Handle and safeguard PII including SSNs throughout the access-request lifecycle in accordance with the Privacy Act.
- Serve as the command's on-site IT point of contact: first-line intake, triage, and escalation of end-user issues, opening and tracking enterprise service tickets to resolution.
- Maintain the enterprise computer inventory of record and facilitate the annual laptop refresh; performed OS updates on 9 NMCI assets and provisioned 9 peripherals.
- Train incoming command members on Navy enterprise IT systems — account use, access request procedures, and the security expectations attached to them.

Operations Coordinator — U.S. Navy, Navy Band Great Lakes, IL

Jun – Nov 2025 · also 2019 – 2020

- Recalled on short notice to run the operations department for a 40-person organization across an 11-state area: processed 128 requests into 111 executed missions in five months.
- Absorbed a complete migration of the command's operations software mid-assignment — rebuilt the engagement contact database from scratch in the new platform and mined the legacy system for the historical records the new platform could not carry forward, with no break in the reporting cadence through cutover.
- Authored 45 recurring reports per year to Navy leadership (SECNAV weekly, outreach, Echelon-2 monthly), maintaining executive visibility of unit activity.
- Designed and delivered technical and professional training to groups of 30+ — one of eight years of formal instruction across the career.

Command Pay & Personnel Administrator — U.S. Navy, Navy Band Southwest, San Diego, CA

Nov 2020 - Sep 2022

- Ran pay, personnel, and travel records administration for a 45-member activity outside own specialty; processed 140 system transactions and 21 gain/loss packages with sustained accuracy in a records system holding PII for every member.
- Earned the A16A Command Pay & Personnel Administrator classification; Sailor of the Quarter, 3rd Qtr FY21.

Earlier U.S. Navy assignments — 2002 - 2020

Navy Recruiter (NRD Chicago, 2014-2017; Advanced Recruiter, 7 Gold Wreath awards) · Command Leading Petty Officer, 36 personnel, zero liberty or safety incidents · Fiscal Petty Officer, Government Purchase Card program (107 requests, zero discrepancies) · Command Career Counselor (98% retention) · Supply Petty Officer (\$250K inventory, 100% accountability) · ESAMS safety supervisor (zero discrepancies on annual inspection) · Public Affairs supervisor.

Naval Service Training Command Sailor of the Year, FY19 · Navy & Marine Corps Commendation Medal · 6 Navy & Marine Corps Achievement Medals · Good Conduct Medal (7).

PROJECTS

SSH Detect & Respond — Python · github.com/zellerbrook/ssh-detect-respond

A from-scratch build of the log-ingestion layer that sits underneath brute-force detection tools like fail2ban and CrowdSec. Parses SSH authentication logs into structured events (timestamp, source IP, username, outcome) and tails live files, surviving log rotation and in-place truncation — a failure mode where naive monitors go silently blind while still appearing healthy. pytest suite covers parsing, rotation, and truncation.

Home pentesting lab — VirtualBox: Kali Linux attacker VM against Metasploitable 2, Windows 7, and Windows 10 targets — enumeration, exploitation, and post-exploitation practice.

CERTIFICATIONS

Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate (2024) · Google IT Support Professional Certificate (2024) · Fortinet Networking Fundamentals (2025) · TryHackMe SOC Level 1 (2025) · TryHackMe Cyber Security 101 (2025) · ZTM Complete Python Developer (2026) · ZTM DevOps Bootcamp: Linux Sysadmin (2026) · ZTM Bash Scripting (2026) · ZTM Introduction to Git & GitHub (2026) · Anthropic Claude 101, Claude Code 101 & Introduction to Claude Cowork (2026) · Google AI Essentials (2024)

EDUCATION

M.S. Education — St. Joseph's College of Maine, 2013 (completed while serving full-time)

B.M. Jazz Performance — Southern Illinois University Edwardsville, 1999